(2) Remove the lower nuts and bolts from the axle bracket and remove the shock absorber.

INSTALLATION

(1) Position the lower retainer and grommet on the upper stud. Insert the shock absorber through the shock bracket hole.

(2) Install the lower bolts and nuts. Tighten nuts to 28 N·m (250 in. lbs.).

(3) Install the upper grommet and retainer on the stud and install the nut and tighten to 23 N·m (17 ft. lbs.).

SPRING

DESCRIPTION

The coil springs mount up in the wheelhouse which is part of the unitized body bracket. A rubber doughnut isolator is located between the top of the spring and the bracket. The bottom of the spring seats on a axle pad.

OPERATION

The coil springs control ride quality and maintain proper ride height. The isolators provide road noise isolation.

REMOVAL

(1) Raise and support the vehicle.

(2) Remove the wheel and tire assemblies.

(3) Position a hydraulic jack under the axle to support it.

(4) Remove the front shocks at the lower mountings, (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/FRONT/SHOCK - REMOVAL).

(5) Remove the ABS wire mounting brackets at the axle. (if equipped)

(6) Remove lower suspension arms mounting nuts and bolts from the frame, (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/FRONT/LOWER CONTROL ARM - REMOVAL).

(7) Remove the track bar from the axle bracket, (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/FRONT/TRACK BAR - REMOVAL).

(8) Remove the right side of the drag link from the right side knuckle, (Refer to 19 - STEERING/LINKAGE/DRAG LINK - REMOVAL).

(9) Lower the axle until the spring is free from the upper mount.

NOTE: Rotation of the spring and prying down slightly on the axle will aid in removal.

(10) Remove the upper spring isolator. (if needed)

(11) Pull jounce bumper out of mount. (if needed)

INSTALLATION

(1) Install jounce bumper into mount.

(2) Install the spring isolator.

NOTE: Rotation of the spring and prying down slightly on the axle will aid in installation.

(3) Position the coil spring on the axle pad. It may be necessary to rotate the spring while installing.

(4) Raise the axle into position until the spring seats in the upper mount.

(5) Install the shock at the axle, (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/FRONT/SHOCK - INSTALLATION).

(6) Install the ABS wire mounting brackets at the axle (if equipped).

(7) Install the track bar to the axle bracket, (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/FRONT/TRACK BAR - INSTALLATION).

(8) Install the lower suspension arms to the frame. Install mounting bolts and nuts finger tight, (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/FRONT/LOWER CONTROL ARM - INSTALLATION).

(9) Install the drag link to the right side knuckle, (Refer to 19 - STEERING/LINKAGE/DRAG LINK - INSTALLATION).

(10) Remove the hydraulic jack from under the axle.

(11) Install the wheel and tire assemblies, (Refer to 22 - TIRES/WHEELS/WHEELS - STANDARD PROCEDURE).

(12) Remove the supports and lower the vehicle.

(13) Tighten the lower suspension arms nuts to 115 N·m (85 ft. lbs.) at normal ride height with the vehicle weight.

STABILIZER BAR

DESCRIPTION

The spring steel bar extends across the top of the chassis frame rails. Links are connected from the bar to the axle brackets. The stabilizer bar and links are isolated by rubber bushings.

OPERATION

The stabilizer bar is used to control vehicle body roll during turns. The bar helps to control the vehicle body in relationship to the suspension.

REMOVAL

(1) Remove upper link nuts (Fig. 9) and separate the links from the stabilizer bar with Remover MB-991113.

(2) Remove front bumper valence.

(3) Remove stabilizer retainer bolts (Fig. 9) and remove retainers.

(4) Remove stabilizer bar.